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DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR  
Chief News Editor

A meeting, which was held between Sheikh Khaled Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, reflects the UAE's approach of combining deterrence with diplomacy to promote regional security, Dr Anwar Mohammed Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said in a post on X platform.

Sheikh Khaled met Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Leaders Summit in New Delhi as part of a series of meetings with leaders attending the gathering.

"The meeting reflects the UAE's approach based on the two pillars of deterrence and diplomacy, neither of which can be effective without the other," Gargash said in a post on X.

"Deterrence strengthens the credibility of diplomacy, while diplomacy succeeds when it proceeds from a position of parity and capability," he said, adding that the combination offered the best path towards stable and sustainable regional security.

#### Promoting stability

During their meeting, Sheikh Khaled and Pezeshkian discussed regional and international issues of mutual interest and the importance of supporting efforts to promote calm, de-escalation and stability in the region.

The two sides also discussed enhancing prospects for peace and development for the region's peoples.

Gargash said Pezeshkian had adopted what he described as balanced and rational positions and statements during the prolonged crisis, adding that such positions should not be overlooked at what he called a delicate stage. His comments came as the UAE continues to emphasise diplomacy and de-escalation

# UAE-Iran meeting reflects policy of deterrence, diplomacy: Gargash

BRICS NATIONS URGE 'MAXIMUM RESTRAINT' AS MIDDLE EAST TENSIONS RISE



■ Sheikh Khaled meets Iran President Masoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the BRICS summit.

alongside measures aimed at safeguarding regional security and stability.

Meanwhile, members of the 11-nation BRICS group including China, Russia, Iran and India called for calm in the Middle East, overcoming earlier divisions to issue a joint statement.

Chinese President Xi Jinping, who joined Russian, Iranian, Indian and other leaders in the Indian capital, told the summit that the Middle East war "does not serve the common interests of the international community".

Foreign ministers of the BRICS grouping had failed to agree on a joint statement when they met in New Delhi in May.

But leaders issued a statement

on Saturday after intense diplomatic efforts by host India, as the bloc seeks to bolster its global influence and address conflict, trade turbulence and energy security.

#### Calling for calm

"We express deep concern over the continued escalation of tensions in Middle East/West Asia," the joint statement said, adding the countries "call for exercising maximum restraint, as well as avoiding actions that could further aggravate the situation".

BRICS was created in 2009 as a forum for major emerging economies seeking greater influence in institutions dominated by Western powers. "We have to

transform this pyramid of privilege into a platform of partnership," Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi told Xi, Russian President Vladimir Putin, Pezeshkian and other leaders.

Modi, opening the two-day summit, called for a system "where every country has a voice, every member has a stake and humanity's development is at the centre of every effort".

Pezeshkian attended the summit shortly after warning that the Middle East does not need the United States to be a "regional policeman", with the two countries at war and tensions threatening the vital Strait of Hormuz.

— With inputs from agencies

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#### TOUCHING MOMENT

Khaled's  
farewell gesture  
wins hearts,  
goes viral

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Some moments reveal more about a leader than any formal speech or summit meeting. For Sheikh Khaled, one such moment came at the very end of his visit to India.

Sheikh Khaled had already begun making his way towards his aircraft when he turned around, walked back towards the driver who had accompanied him and shook his hand before departing.

The brief exchange, captured on video and widely circulated on social media, quickly attracted praise from users who saw in it a simple expression of gratitude and humility.

For many of those sharing the footage, it was the spontaneity of the gesture that stood out. Posts accompanying the video described the moment as reflecting the values associated with the school of the UAE's Founding Father, the late Sheikh Zayed Bin Sultan Al Nahyan, respect for people, regardless of position, and appreciation for those who serve.

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# Arabian Travel Market opens with technology, growth on the agenda

Rebuilding confidence and strengthening partnerships to be the main focus

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The Arabian Travel Market (ATM) opens today as the international travel and tourism industry returns to Dubai for four days of business, networking and discussions on how the sector moves into its next phase following nearly seven months of disruption on account of the US-Iran war.

The 33rd edition of ATM will run until September 17 at Dubai World Trade Centre, bringing together airlines, tourism authorities, hotels, destinations, technology companies, travel buyers and industry professionals.

#### Important event

Why is the event so important this year? Because nearly seven months into the US-Iran war, travel patterns across the region have shifted, international booking windows have shortened and hotels have had to work harder to

● The question hanging over ATM will be more about what recovery will look like, how quickly confidence returns and how the industry adapts to a changed market.

balance occupancy, room rates and profitability.

The question hanging over ATM will therefore be less about whether travellers still want to travel — and more about what recovery will look like, how quickly confidence returns and how the industry adapts to a changed market. ATM 2026 will put rebuilding confidence and strengthening partnerships high on the agenda.

Danielle Curtis, Regional Portfolio Director — UAE, RX Global, said the industry had faced "its share of challenges in recent months", reinforcing the value of bringing the travel community together in person.

"It is great to be back, and I'm looking forward to seeing the conversations, partnerships and opportunities that emerge

over the course of the show," she said.

Against that backdrop, technology will be one of the biggest themes at ATM 2026.

#### ATM Travel Tech

The event will see the debut of ATM Travel Tech, a dedicated co-located show featuring more than 180 exhibitors from 30 countries across two halls. An 850-square-metre Tech & Innovation Hub will focus on artificial intelligence, virtual and augmented reality, robotics, fintech and green technologies.

The Future Stage will examine AI and automation, data and digital transformation, fintech, immersive technology, robotics and next-generation travel platforms.

Dr Marwan Alzarouni, CEO, AI at Dubai's Department of Economy and Tourism, will open the stage with a session on AI's role in reshaping travel.

Senior representatives from Sabre, Trip.com, Tripadvisor, Wego, MakeMyTrip, RateGain and Visa will also discuss subjects including agentic AI, online travel agencies, digital discovery and the evolving travel supply chain.

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IN FOCUS

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# UAE slams Saudi oil pipeline attack

ABU DHABI

The UAE has condemned the attacks targeting the East-West oil pipeline in the cities of Riyadh and Madina in Saudi Arabia, using several drones launched from Iraqi territories, which resulted in a number of injuries.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) affirmed that these hostile attacks constitute a flagrant violation of the sovereignty of Saudi Arabia and a threat to its security and stability.

The Ministry reaffirmed the UAE's solidarity with Saudi Arabia and its support for all measures aimed at safeguarding its security and stability.

Saudi authorities said on Friday that drones launched from Iraq led to the temporary closure of a crucial oil export route used to bypass the lockdown of the Strait of Hormuz.

— WAM

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